



Harouna and Fatoumata Diarra, both 10 and in third grade at Chettou Primary School, hold a tree they will plant as part of World Earth Day celebrations in Mali.

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Spotlight on the Global Climate, Environment, Energy, and Disaster Risk Reduction Thematic Fund 2024



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UNICEF works across 12 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to bring about positive change for children. The Global Climate, Environment, Energy, and Disaster Risk Reduction Thematic Fund makes vital contributions to multiple SDGs: SDG 3, SDG 4, SDG 6, SDG 7, SDG 11 and SDG 13.

1. UNICEF's Global Climate, Environment, Energy, and Disaster Risk Reduction Thematic Fund: Building a resilient future for children

The climate crisis is the defining challenge of our time, and its impacts are hitting children hardest. From rising temperatures and toxic air to floods, droughts and displacement, climate and environmental threats are placing children's health, learning and safety at increasing risk. More than 1 billion children are already exposed to extreme climate hazards. The need for action is urgent. Yet investment remains dangerously low.

UNICEF is working to change this – not just through programmes, but by transforming the systems that shape children's lives. The Global Climate, Environment, Energy, and Disaster Risk Reduction (CEED) Thematic Fund is UNICEF's most strategic vehicle for advancing climate resilience and environmental sustainability at scale.

This is not just a financing mechanism. It is a catalyst for systemic change. Unlike highly earmarked and short-term funds, flexible funding allows UNICEF to align with national priorities, plan for the long term and reach children who are too often left behind.

Rooted in equity, resilience and partnership, the Global CEED Thematic Fund reflects a simple but urgent truth: establishing climate-resilient services and protecting children from climate and environmental hazards is essential to the well-being and future of every child.

2. Financial results

Investment catalysing progress for generations

Progress towards a climate-resilient future for children is only possible thanks to partners who invest not only in programmes, but in the systems that sustain them.

In 2024, the Global CEED Thematic Fund mobilized US\$6.7 million in contributions from committed private and public sector partners. UNICEF extends sincere thanks to the Government of Sweden, and private sector partners, who contributed to the Fund, including through National Committees.

These flexible, catalytic investments enable UNICEF to strengthen climate-resilient services and systems, protect children against climate disasters and environmental hazards, and support child-focused environmental action, laying the foundation for long-term protection and opportunity in a changing climate and degrading environment.

Thanks to this visionary support, UNICEF is helping countries act faster, build stronger systems and deliver more for every child.

“The climate crisis is a child rights crisis. Thanks to our partners, UNICEF is delivering real solutions that protect children today and strengthen the systems that will safeguard their future. Your commitment is helping drive climate action at scale with children at the centre.”

Kitty van der Heijden, Deputy Executive Director, Partnerships, UNICEF

Top Global CEED Thematic Fund partners by contributions received, 2024¹

Sector	Donor	Amount (US\$)
Public	Sweden	5,828,072*
	Spanish Committee for UNICEF	327,680
	Finnish Committee for UNICEF	130,488
	United Kingdom Committee for UNICEF	123,750
Private	Japan Committee for UNICEF	100,000
	Swedish Committee for UNICEF	77,534
	UNICEF India Country Office PSFR	45,000
	Italian Committee for UNICEF – Foundation Onlus	22,500
	UNICEF Mexico Country Office PSFR	33,750
Grand Total		6,688,774

Note: Numbers may not add up due to rounding. PSFR: Private sector fundraising.

* The Government of Sweden committed US\$11 million to the Global CEED Thematic Fund in 2024. The funds are disbursed over a two-year period (2024–2025).

¹ The thematic funding contributions relate to the Strategic Plan 2022–2025.



Group photo of young girls from the Akamasoa center taken during the celebration of Earth Hour in Antananarivo, Madagascar with the Ministry of Youth and Sports and the Scout Federation.

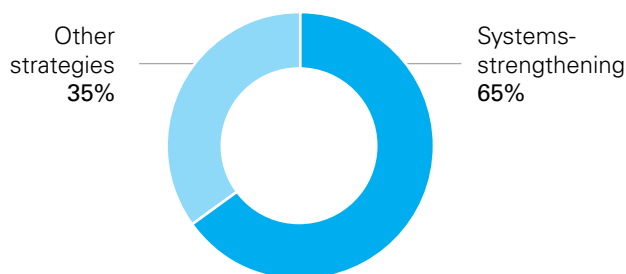
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Why flexible funding matters

This flexible funding does not just respond to climate disasters and environmental hazards; it builds the systems that protect children from them. With flexible, multi-year funding invested over the four-year period of UNICEF's Strategic Plan (2022–2025), UNICEF drives long-term partnerships, rapid adaptation to emerging needs, and solutions that put children at the centre of climate and environmental action. UNICEF also demonstrates results for scale, acting as an important catalyst across the CEED portfolio.

In 2024, UNICEF incurred US\$0.6 million of Global CEED thematic funding expense paving the way for accelerated climate and environmental action focused on children in 2025, amplified by the landmark partnership with the Government of Sweden. Every flexible dollar spent helps bring the world closer to a future where children are protected from climate risks and equipped to thrive in a more resilient, sustainable world.

UNICEF expense by programme strategy, 2024



In 2024, **65 per cent** of CEED thematic funding was spent on climate action in child-critical systems.

Note: The category 'other' consists of strategies that enable systems-strengthening, including advocacy and communications; social and behaviour change; data and research; digital transformation; innovation; partnerships and engagement; and support to programme delivery.

A call to scale what works

Achieving the SDGs is not a distant ambition; it is an urgent necessity. The climate crisis is accelerating, and children are on the front lines. Meeting this challenge requires a global shift: from short-term response to long-term resilience, and from fragmented projects to child-focused systems that can withstand shocks and protect development gains.

The Global CEED Thematic Fund is UNICEF's most strategic tool for making that shift possible. It enables countries to strengthen essential services, respond to climate disasters and environmental hazards, and empower children and youth as leaders of climate action.

Now is the time to act. We invite more partners to join us in building a world where every child can grow up safe, healthy and able to reach their full potential – on a planet that can sustain them.



Transparency with Thematic Funding

UNICEF has a strong financial transparency record, including for thematic funding. We encourage UNICEF partners to the Global CEED Thematic Fund to visit the Transparency Portal and access real-time information on spending in the countries receiving funds.

3. The footprint of the Global CEED Thematic Fund

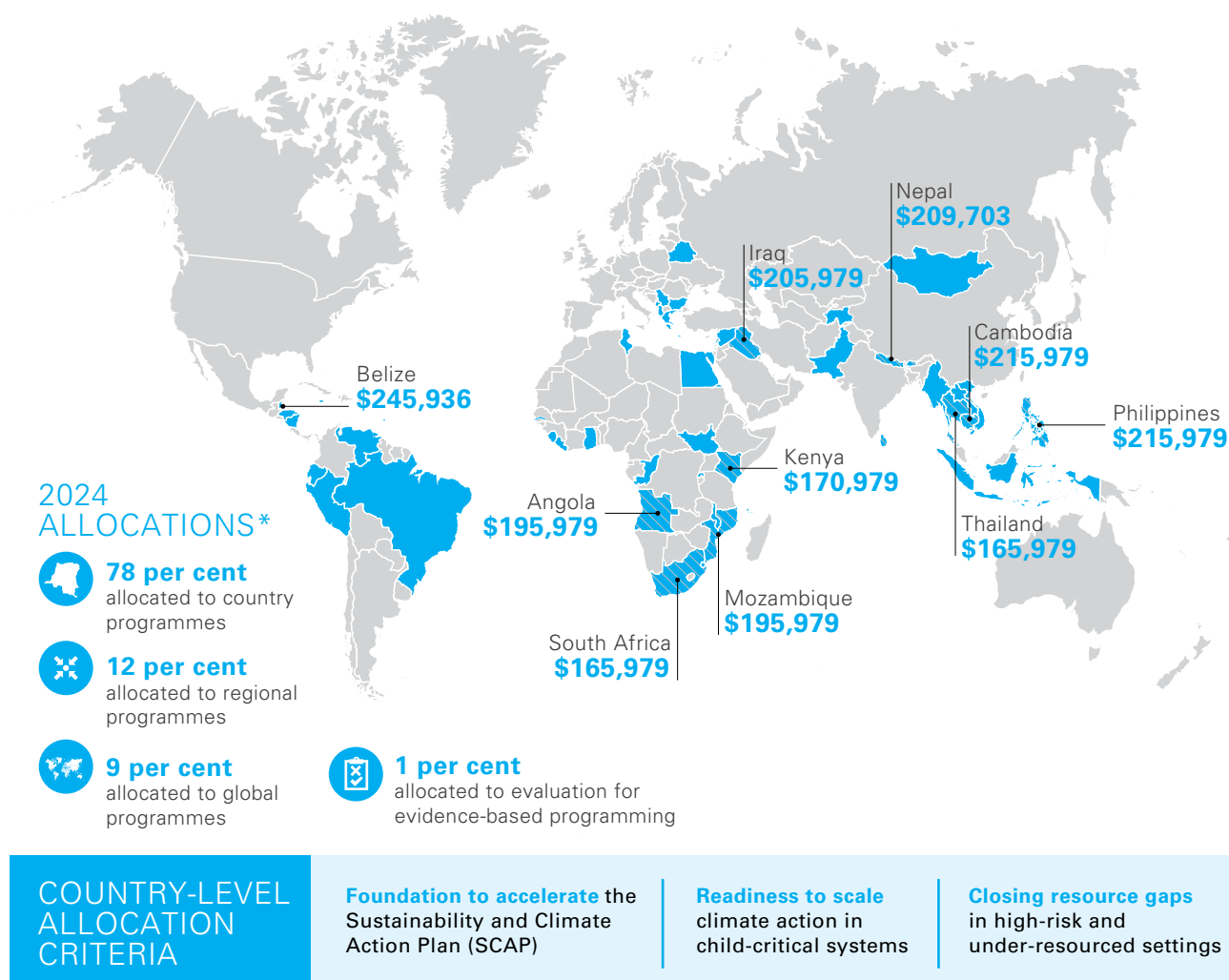
The Global CEED Thematic Fund delivers impact across every UNICEF region through a layered, strategic model designed to accelerate child-focused climate action:

- At the **country level**: Investments support climate-resilient solutions in essential sectors such as education, water and sanitation, health and social protection.
- At the **regional level**: Investments strengthen technical capacity, coordination and cross-country learning, and adoption of promising practices.

- At the **global level**: Investments enable UNICEF's technical leadership in the development of public goods, policy guidance and innovations to embed children's rights into climate and disaster risk strategies.

Together, these levels work in synergy — enabling UNICEF to scale climate action and strengthen essential services so they can better protect children now and in the future.

Global CEED Thematic Fund allocations around the world²



Note: The map is stylized and not to scale. It does not reflect a position by UNICEF on the legal status of any country or area or the delimitation of any frontiers

² The map shows all countries that received allocations from the Global CEED Thematic Fund between 2022 and 2024. The 10 highest allocations in 2024 are shown with full amounts.

4. From programmes to policy: A systems shift in climate and environmental action

The scale of unmet need in child and family climate resilience is vast, but UNICEF's response is equally bold. Across every region, the Global CEED Thematic Fund is driving a paradigm shift – moving from short term, standalone service delivery, to strong, integrated systems that place climate resilience at the core of every child's right to survive and thrive.

UNICEF's systems-strengthening model is anchored in workforce development, policy and legislative reform, social and behaviour change, data and evidence, infrastructure for service delivery and sustainable financing – and proven in delivering measurable and holistic results.

In 2024, thematic funding played a catalytic role in accelerating progress across UNICEF's broader climate resilience programming, strengthening national systems and empowering community platforms to deliver impact where it matters most.

Below are some headline sector results for which thematic funding for CEED, as part of a broader portfolio of funding, was a key contributor.

Legal and policy change

Strengthening climate resilience starts with changing the rules that govern it. UNICEF works alongside governments to draft national policies, revise legislation and mobilize public budgets to ensure that climate resilience is reflected not just in practice but in law.

In 2024, UNICEF supported 61 countries to integrate child-focused climate risk assessments into national water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) and climate policies. UNICEF also supported five countries to embed children's vulnerabilities and perspectives into National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans.

UNICEF's policy advocacy with thematic funding helped align climate resilience with national development priorities and unlock new streams of domestic financing:

- In **Honduras**, UNICEF supported the integration of child-focused criteria into the Climate Change Law, the National Adaptation Plan and the official guide for municipal emergency plans. These actions scale child-led climate action nationally and enhance resilience. UNICEF also helped strengthen the capacities of **60 youth** and **90 officials** in 6 municipalities, enabling over **600 people** to engage in climate adaptation and mitigation.
- In three Caribbean countries – **Barbados**, **Grenada**, and **Saint Kitts and Nevis** – policy and programmatic silos between social protection and climate change are narrowing. UNICEF support to the

governments through evidence generation, advocacy and targeted capacity-building is helping to scale up adaptation and mitigation efforts, leading to shock-responsive social protection systems.

- In **Iraq**, UNICEF has played a pivotal role in supporting the Government of Iraq in the consultations for and drafting of the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC 3.0), specifically the chapters on water and waste. UNICEF also supported the participation of adolescents and young people in consultations, ensuring the NDC 3.0 is child- and youth-sensitive to fulfil its commitment to young people in climate action.

Data, research and evidence for CEED solutions

Data and evidence are the foundation of effective climate resilience programming. They guide decision-making, ensure that resources reach the communities most vulnerable to climate impacts, and help measure the real-world impact of investments.



Mozambique, Nadia João (10) walks through the rubble of her school destroyed by storm Freddy. She is distressed by being unable to attend class and fears her family will lose their crops due to the floods.

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A girl plays at a beach in Tarawa, Kiribati. As one of the countries most vulnerable to climate change, Kiribati faces rising sea levels and increasing erosion that threaten homes and livelihoods.

© UNICEF/UNI692323/Ijazah

UNICEF is committed to strengthening the data systems and research capacities that drive smarter, more equitable climate responses. By helping governments identify who is being left behind – and what works to reach them – UNICEF enables countries to expand services sustainably and make climate resilience systems more accountable.

- In 2024, UNICEF completed multisectoral studies in 67 countries on how climate, environmental and disaster risks impact children – a 49 per cent increase from 2023. These studies support risk-informed programming, policy and advocacy engagement with governments, donors and partners.

Around the world, UNICEF's technical support with thematic funding is helping governments leverage data to improve outcomes for children:

- In **Kenya**, UNICEF supported a subnational children's climate and disaster risk assessment, using a **Children's Climate and Disaster Risk Model**. Findings have helped identify how children are uniquely exposed and vulnerable to climate risks and other environmental shocks in each of Kenya's 47 counties, securing the evidence base for targeted interventions to improve the future of Kenyan children.
- In **Brazil**, UNICEF collaborated with the government to develop a new **Children's Environmental Health Index**, generating data on environmental hazards affecting children's health in every municipality – helping to support local environmental health action focused on children.

Workforce development

Behind every child benefiting from climate resilience initiatives is a dedicated changemaker – a teacher, community leader, or youth advocate – equipped with the knowledge and skills to make a difference.

The Global CEED Thematic Fund invests in this essential human infrastructure, helping countries train their front-line workforce to deliver impactful services for children, such as climate-resilient education.

In 2024, UNICEF supported 91 countries to integrate green skills and climate-related content into education systems and learning curricula. This included training teachers and staff, developing environment-focused content, and providing digital tools to equip children and young people with the skills to navigate and shape a changing world.

Thematic funding investments were critical to strengthening workforce capacity in a number of countries:

- In **Kosovo**,³ UNICEF's Climate Landscape Analysis for Children (CLAC) identified climate risks impacting children and recommended actions to build resilience. Based on these findings, an assessment of Kosovo's pre-university curricula on green skills was conducted, laying the groundwork for developing teacher training modules on climate change and air quality.
- In **Albania**, UNICEF supported a midterm review of the National Education Strategy, making green skills a core component of the country's vision for future-ready learners.

This is how change begins – not just with tools or infrastructure, but with people who are prepared to lead the way.

³ References to Kosovo in this document shall be understood to be in the context of the United Nations Security Council Resolution 1244 (1999).

Infrastructure for service delivery

The Global CEED Thematic Fund invests in climate-resilient physical infrastructure, including the deployment of sustainable energy systems where relevant. These solutions help reduce the carbon footprint of critical services such as health care, education and water, while making them more reliable and resilient.

UNICEF plays a vital role in keeping these systems running, in close collaboration with government partners and communities. In 2024, sustainable energy solutions were deployed in health-care facilities across 66 countries, and 69 countries benefited from solar-powered water systems.

Thematic funding supports these efforts at country level:

- In **Comoros**, UNICEF brought sustainable solar energy to the unelectrified village of Outsa, improving daily life for its **808 residents** by powering the health centre, school and village square – ensuring essential services and community activities can thrive.

Youth action for lasting impact

Empowering young people to engage in climate action is central to UNICEF's work. UNICEF helps remove barriers for engagement and invests in equipping young people to lead, act and advocate for a safer, more sustainable future.

In 2024, through UNICEF's flagship initiative Green Rising, 11 million young people in 30 countries participated in climate-focused interventions. These young leaders planted 19 million trees, conserved 600 million litres of water and recycled over 75,000 kilograms of waste.

At the global level, UNICEF's advocacy at the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change's 29th Conference of the Parties (COP29) in Azerbaijan secured critical policy commitments, integrated child-specific indicators into global adaptation and climate finance goals, and established a 'Group of Friends' to advance children's rights in international climate negotiations.

Thematic funding supported tailored community-level initiatives:

- In **Bulgaria**, UNICEF played a pivotal role in mobilizing youth climate action and ensuring young people's voices were reflected in national environmental policymaking. Over **510 adolescents** helped shape the national conversation on climate by participating in consultations, advocacy workshops and policy dialogues.

- In **Egypt**, UNICEF's youth empowerment programmes elevated youth voices on national and global platforms, including **1,400 adolescents and youth** who participated in the 2024 Local Conference of Youth and contributed to Egypt's Youth Statement and the Global Youth Statement presented at the 19th Conference of Youth (COY19) and COP29. UNICEF also supported the creation of the EG Youth 4 Climate Committee, enabling 10 youth to attend COP29 as official party negotiators.

Results that last

In 2024, UNICEF made significant strides in strengthening children's resilience in a rapidly changing climate and environment. The Global CEED Thematic Fund contributed to meaningful progress at scale:

- The number of countries with climate programmes for children increased from 68 to **119**, helping embed climate action across key systems that children rely on for services.
- **69 governments** were supported to update their environmental and disaster management policies to better address children's climate resilience needs.
- In **104 countries**, UNICEF worked with governments to integrate child-focused disaster risk reduction activities into critical sectors such as health, education, water, sanitation and social protection.
- These efforts enabled **66 governments** to improve disaster preparedness and anticipatory action protocols, helping reduce the impact of predictable climate hazards on children and communities.

These results show what is possible when flexible, child-focused climate investments strengthen systems – not just for today, but for generations to come.



Scan the QR code or click on the image to read UNICEF's Data Companion and Scorecard for more information on progress against SDG and Strategic Plan targets. Thematic Funding as part of UNICEF's overall funding portfolio contributes to this progress.

5. Impact story

Innovative finance is reshaping cyclone resilience and child-responsive disaster management in Madagascar

When cyclones strike, learning stops – but in Madagascar, UNICEF is changing that.

Each year, Madagascar's children brace for storm season. Between 2000 and 2024, more than 50 tropical storms and cyclones battered the island, affecting over 6 million people. In 2021 alone, 12.9 million children were exposed. Schools collapse, homes flood, and health systems falter. With nearly 60 per cent of the population under 25, it is children who pay the highest price, with their safety, education and futures at risk.

The country's education system is particularly vulnerable. In 2022, only 62 per cent of girls and 57 per cent of boys completed primary school. As storms grow more intense, children's right to learn is increasingly being jeopardized.

A new approach: from crisis response to climate resilience

To break this cycle, UNICEF Madagascar is using innovative finance as a transformative model of risk reduction and sustainable recovery. The Today & Tomorrow initiative reduces children's disaster risk by building individual, community and system-wide resilience.

- The Today component reduces risk by strengthening government and local capacities to protect children and communities before cyclones strike. Investments reduce risks for populations most vulnerable to cyclone impacts by supporting safer schools, improved early warning systems, and climate-resilient health and water services.
- The Tomorrow component deploys rapid insurance payouts after cyclones, to save lives, restore services, build resilience and protect children's well-being. The funds provide life-saving and well-being support, such as for health care, education supplies, cash assistance and food for children and families.

Impact at a glance

Thanks to Today & Tomorrow insurance payouts between 2023 and 2024, UNICEF's education sector in Madagascar provided:

- Emergency kits for 25,000 children



At the Public Primary School of Terabovo in Madagascar, 10-year-old Takaloaze, a 4th-grade student, holds a small tree sapling ready to be planted on the school grounds.

© UNICEF/UNI769034/Andrianantenaina

- Mental health and psychosocial support training for 250 educators
- 'Back to school' training for over 1,000 teachers, parents and directors
- Building supplies and furniture for 10,000 students
- Restoration and rebuilding of 3 educational facilities.

Your investment, their future

In Madagascar, tropical cyclones cause 85 per cent of all disaster losses, costing an average of US\$87 million annually, and up to US\$810 million in severe cases. Emergency costs can reach US\$190 million, amounting to 4 per cent of national gross domestic product.

But we know the returns from early action: every \$1 invested in disaster preparedness saves \$15 in post-disaster recovery.⁴ And \$1 spent on disaster-resilient infrastructure saves \$4.⁵

With your support, we are helping Madagascar build a safer future for every child where education does not stop when storms begin.

"The flexibility of this funding is a game changer. It allows us to respond where needs are greatest – not just where resources happen to be pre-allocated."

– Anneleen Van Uffelen, UNICEF CEED Specialist, Madagascar

⁴ United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (2023) (cited in UNDRR *Global Assessment Report on Disaster Risk Reduction 2025: Resilience Pays: Financing and Investing for our Future* pp. 169)

⁵ Hallegatte, S.; Rentschler, J.; Rozenberg, J. (2019). *Lifelines: The Resilient Infrastructure Opportunity. Sustainable Infrastructure*. © World Bank.



Camarines Sur, Philippines, Hygiene kits were distributed by UNICEF and partner Plan International Philippines in one of the communities hardest hit by Severe Tropical Storm Kristine.

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6. Hearing from our donors and partners

Sweden and UNICEF: Scaling climate resilience for every child

The Government of Sweden is a key partner of UNICEF's Global CEED Thematic Fund, demonstrating global leadership through Sida's landmark 2024 investment. This flexible, catalytic funding leverages UNICEF's expertise to target the most critical climate challenges for children – allocated equally between climate-resilient WASH interventions and broader climate action.

This innovative funding approach has empowered UNICEF to implement solutions across 36 countries – from climate-smart education and green skills, early warning systems

and disaster risk reduction, to resilient infrastructure and services – demonstrating how flexible thematic support can simultaneously tackle immediate climate risks and build long-term systemic resilience.

By responding to evolving global challenges, Sweden's strategic investment delivers comprehensive protection for children's rights – directly aligned with UNICEF's Sustainability and Climate Action Plan (SCAP) – while laying the foundation for a sustainable future where every child can grow up safe, healthy and climate-resilient.

Spotlight on the Global CEED Thematic Fund

Jen Stephens
Global Lead, Climate, Environment,
Energy and Disaster Risk Reduction

UNICEF Programme Group
New York, United States
www.unicef.org

Programme Coordination Unit
Private Fundraising and Partnerships Division, Geneva
Public Partnerships Division, New York
programmecoordination@unicef.org

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July 2025

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for every child